A Pilgrimage

I shall find, just past the byre, that once-familiar track
Trudge through the sharn and skirt the ruined concrete tank
Which drank burns and spewed our water, brown with peat
Wind past someone else's yowes to Klondike, thistle-thick
Pass by the rotting posts where stood the cattle gate
And on.

I shall find in friendly hills the silent Loomi Shun
Where, beguiled by rippling trout-rings, that peerie boy
Once worm-fished in patient unavailing hope
Where faithful rain-goose pair have scraped their nest
And heather-berries still taste sweet and clean
And up.

I shall find the mouldering *Tern* in memory's secret noost
Launch her down the beach and hoist the sail
Take her through the narrows, out the voe
Past mackerel grounds and coal-deep Swarbacks Minn
Tack her under the guns, lurching into the cryptic ocean
And beyond.

Chris Adie